

## BOUNCING FORWARD

FREE · SEVEN STEPS · SEVEN HONEST PAGES

# Your 7 Step Reflection Journal

*A seven-step reflection journal — one honest page a step,  
and one small action at the end.*

### A NOTE FROM MAHER

You don't need to have had a great loss to open this journal. You just need to be human. Seven days is not long enough to write your whole story — it is long enough to tell yourself the truth once a day, and to see what that changes. Each step asks only two questions. Answer as you are today. Not who you were before. Not who you intend to become. Here. Now.

***Bounce forward. — Maher Kaddoura***

### BEFORE YOU BEGIN — MY FOOTING TODAY

*No one is keeping score. Circle the number that is honestly true today — you'll return to this scale after Step 7.*

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| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|----|

*Barely standing*

*Steady on my feet*

## STEP 1

# The Honest Sentence

*Every journey needs a true starting point, and this page is yours. Today is not about fixing anything — only about telling yourself the truth, in your own words.*

**What actually happened? Write it plainly — no softening, no headline version.**

*Start with: "What happened was..."*

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**What do you wish people understood about what this has been like for you?**

*Finish this: "What most people don't see is..."*

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*"The map that lies about the terrain is not a kindness to the traveller. It is a danger."*

— Maher Kaddoura, Bouncing Forward

## STEP 2

## What It Took, What Remains

*A setback takes things — some visible, some quiet. Naming what's gone is not dwelling on it; it's taking honest stock, and it only has to be done once.*

**What has this setback taken from you — the obvious things, and the quiet ones?**

*List them plainly — the big and the small belong on the same page.*

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**What has it not been able to take?**

*Start with: "It could not take..."*

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*"You can accept a reality while still finding it unjust. That tension is not a contradiction — it is the truth of most significant setbacks."*

— Maher Kaddoura, **Bouncing Forward**

## STEP 3

## The Question Underneath

*Some thoughts circle and some thoughts move. Today, notice the difference between the question that loops without an answer and the question that leads somewhere.*

**What question do you keep asking that never gives you an answer?**

*Write the question exactly as it sounds in your head.*

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**If that question took one step forward, what would it become?**

*Try turning "why..." into "what now..." or "how..."*

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*"There is a difference between reflection and rumination. Reflection asks: what is this experience teaching me?"*

— Maher Kaddoura, **Bouncing Forward**

## STEP 4

## The Evidence

*You have come through hard things before — that history is evidence, not luck. Today is about finding it and holding it up to the light.*

**When did something knock you down and not keep you down? What happened next?**

*Any season counts — school, work, health, home.*

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**What strength from that season is still available to you now — even if it feels out of reach today?**

*Name it in one word first. Then explain it to yourself.*

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*"Our identity is not shaped by the existence of those storms. It is shaped by the choices we make while navigating through them."*

— Maher Kaddoura, Bouncing Forward

## STEP 5

## One Believable Possibility

*You don't need a five-year plan; you need one possibility you can believe in. Small and real will always beat grand and imaginary.*

**What is one thing you can still imagine wanting — even faintly, even if it feels far away?**

*Faint counts. Write it down before you talk yourself out of it.*

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**“A little better than today” — what would that honestly look like, one month from now?**

*Describe one ordinary day, a month from now — nothing grand.*

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*“Not going back to who you were. Going forward to who you are capable of becoming.”*

— Maher Kaddoura, Bouncing Forward

## STEP 6

## Not Alone

*No one moves through a hard season entirely alone — even when it feels that way. Today is a stocktake of hands, not a test of independence.*

**Who in your life would want to know how you actually are — if you let them?**

*Write the name — even if you're not ready to call them yet.*

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**What is one thing you need right now that you have not yet said out loud?**

*Start with: "What I actually need is..."*

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*"Support flows in both directions, or it does not flow at all."*

— Maher Kaddoura, Bouncing Forward

## STEP 7

## One Small Step

*Seven days of honesty deserve one act of movement. Not a leap — a step, small enough to survive a bad day.*

**What is one small thing you could do this week that your Step 5 answer would thank you for?**

*Ten minutes or less — small enough to survive a bad day.*

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**When exactly will you do it — and who will you tell afterwards?**

*A named day. A named time. A named person.*

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*"Start before you are ready."*

— Maher Kaddoura, Bouncing Forward



WHERE ARE YOU NOW?

AFTER STEP 7 — MY FOOTING TODAY

Same scale, same rule: circle what is honestly true. Then look back at page one.

|   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |    |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|----|
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|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|----|

Barely standing

Steady on my feet

What moved this week — even a little?

One place on the scale counts. So does anything softer than a number.

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**Seven steps is a beginning, not the whole path.** The 30-Day Journal — part of All In — continues your reflective journey: a month of guided pages, the full course, and the complete framework behind the questions you've just answered. When you're ready, it's waiting at [bouncingforward.com](https://bouncingforward.com) → All In.

**Setbacks don't get the last word.**

A closing note from Maher

## Go Forward

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You have seven honest pages behind you, and I will not dress them up as more than they are — or less. Seven days does not rewrite a story. It does something quieter: it proves the truth can be told, once a day, and survived. That proof is yours now. No one can circle it back down.

I wrote *Bouncing Forward* as someone who had experienced a great loss, not as someone who had it figured out. So I won't tell you what comes next for you. I will only tell you what I know: the step you named on the last page is small enough to take, and taking it will teach you more than any page can.

Wherever you go from here — the 30-Day Journal, the book, or simply back into your week — go as you are. That has been the only rule since the first page, and it is the only one that lasts.

**Go forward. Not back to who you were before the setback.  
Forward to who you are when you have walked through it.**

*Bounce forward.*

*Maher Kaddoura*